

Figure 1: MeeGo software architecture

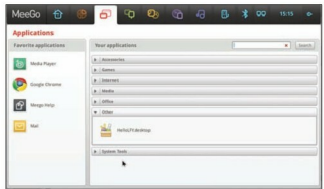


Figure 3: Application launcher

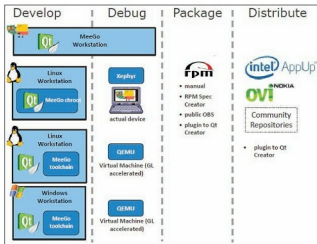


Figure 2: MeeGo development options

Linux machine. The SDK uses the *chroot* mechanism to create a virtualised copy of a software system. The *chrooted* environment uses *xhost* to run graphical applications, as does the MeeGo virtual environment, which enables you to run your application in a simulator.

Once the virtual environment is set up, you can invoke *Qtcreator*, create a project of your choice, and develop, debug, and deploy it as described in the above wiki page. You can optionally build an RPM package as a distributable.

To deploy the application (HelloLFY) on a MeeGo netbook, first copy the application to a thumb drive, and plug the drive in to the MeeGo netbook. Now switch to the terminal mode (Alt + left arrow) and log in as *root* (password: *meego*). Create a folder like */opt/myapps* and copy the application from the thumb drive to the new folder. Next, we need to create a launcher for this application. Create a file named *HelloLFY.desktop* in your (ordinary user account's) home folder, and enter the following code:

```
[Desktop Entry]
Version=1.0
Name=Hello LFY
GenericName=Demo Application
```

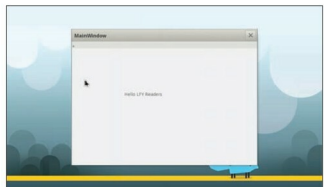


Figure 4: Running application

```
Comment=For demo
Exec=/opt/myapps/HelloLFY
Terminal=false
Type=Application
Categories=Others;
Comment[en_US.UTF-8]=Go with MeeGo
GenericName[en_US.UTF-8]=My apps - HelloLFY
Name[en_US]=HelloLFY.desktop
```

Save the file to the local home folder, and copy it to the */usr/share/applications* folder. This will ensure that the application is added to MeeGo's *Applications* list, as shown in Figure 3. Click the new launcher to launch the application. The running app appears, as shown in Figure 4.

As the market moves towards open platforms, new platforms emerge to claim a share of the pie. MeeGo is backed by two major industry leaders, giving rise to high expectations within the industry and by end-users. Other companies like Acer and Novell are also part of the MeeGo ecosystem. As an end user or a developer, let's hope the competition between platforms brings us better user experiences and functionality.

For more information on MeeGo, visit www.meeGo.com, and www.wiki.meeGo.com/. 

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